



SINGLE SOURCE JUSTIFICATION NOT EXCEEDING THE SIMPLIFIED ACQUISITION THRESHOLD

SECTION 1: IDENTIFICATION OF THE AGENCY AND THE CONTRACTING ACTIVITY

Department of State Contracting Activity	☐ Office of Acquisitions Management ☐ Foreign Service Institute ☐ Office of Foreign Missions ☐ U.S. Mission to the United Nations ☒ Overseas Post: U.S. Embassy Libreville, Gabon
Requiring Activity	Building Automation System Server replacement

SECTION 2: NATURE AND/OR DESCRIPTION OF THE ACTION BEING APPROVED

Approval is requested to award on a sole source basis to **Johnson Controls Inc. (JCI)** for the supplies and/or services described in Section 3 on behalf of the Requiring Activity.

SECTION 3: DESCRIPTION OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES REQUIRED TO MEET THE AGENCY'S

The requirement is to provide replacement of the Building Automation System (BAS) server and three (3) dedicated workstation laptops at U.S. Embassy Libreville, Gabon. The estimated value for the entire period of performance is **\$69,397.44**. These supplies/services require that the contractor supply and install one (1) METASYS-compatible server (DELL PRO MAX TOWER T2 with 32GB RAM), one (1) monitor (LG 27BA45U-B), three (3) METASYS-compatible laptops (DELL PRO MAX 16), all required METASYS Version 13 software licenses, database upgrade and migration, graphics upgrade, onsite installation and commissioning services in Libreville, Gabon, system integration with existing METASYS field equipment, operator training, and all associated travel expenses including DBA insurance. This will allow the Office of Facility Management to maintain critical HVAC control, environmental monitoring, energy management, and life safety system integration throughout the embassy compound, preventing system failure and preserving 14 years of irreplaceable operational data.

The existing BAS is a JCI METASYS system originally installed in 2012 with an upgrade in 2019. The current server has reached storage capacity limits and all software's are obsolete, creating urgent operational risk of system failure.

SECTION 4: IDENTIFICATION OF THE STATUTORY AUTHORITY PERMITTING OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION

In accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 13.106-1(b)(1), the Contracting Officer has deemed only one source reasonably available based on the following:

- ☒ Urgency
- ☐ Exclusive licensing agreements
- ☒ Brand-name



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☐ Industrial mobilization

☒ Other: Proprietary software ownership and exclusive licensing - JCI owns all copyrights and intellectual property rights for METASYS software, which is not available from any other source. Only JCI can legally provide METASYS software licenses and perform database migration using proprietary tools.

SECTION 5: DEMONSTRATION THAT THE PROPOSED CONTRACTOR'S UNIQUE QUALIFICATIONS OR THE NATURE OF THE ACQUISITION REQUIRES USE OF THE AUTHORITY CITED

Urgency

The current BAS server has reached storage capacity limits and is at high risk of catastrophic failure. System failure would result in:

- Complete loss of HVAC control throughout the embassy
- Inability to monitor or respond to environmental alarms
- Potential damage to HVAC equipment from uncontrolled operation (estimated \$50,000-\$100,000 in emergency repairs)
- Compromised comfort and safety for embassy personnel
- Loss of energy management capabilities

The obsolete software cannot receive security patches, creating cybersecurity vulnerabilities and non-compliance with Federal cybersecurity requirements. Each month of delay increases the probability of system failure. A JCI upgrade can be completed within 100 days, while competitive procurement of an alternative system would require 12-18 months, exposing the embassy to unacceptable operational risk during this extended period.

Brand Name and Proprietary Requirements

Only JCI brand METASYS-compatible hardware and software can satisfy this requirement for the following reasons:

- 1. Proprietary Software Ownership:** JCI owns all copyrights, patents, and intellectual property rights for METASYS software. METASYS software is not available for purchase or licensing from any source other than JCI. No third-party manufacturers or vendors can legally provide, install, or configure METASYS software. The existing system database and programming are entirely dependent on METASYS software architecture and cannot be migrated to any alternative platform without complete system replacement.
- 2. System Compatibility:** The new server and laptops must integrate seamlessly with existing METASYS field controllers, sensors, actuators, and HVAC equipment valued at over \$200,000 throughout the embassy compound. JCI maintains exclusive technical specifications for METASYS-compatible hardware. METASYS uses proprietary communication protocols (N2, BACnet with JCI-specific extensions) that require JCI-certified hardware. Non-JCI hardware would result in system instability, loss of communication with field devices, database corruption, and voided warranties on \$200,000+ of existing METASYS equipment.



3. Database Migration: The existing BAS database contains 14 years of critical operational data (2012-present) including complete system programming, historical trend data, alarm histories, custom graphics, and integration configurations. JCI's proprietary database migration tools are the only means to extract and convert this data to the current METASYS format. No third-party contractor possesses these proprietary tools, technical documentation, or legal authorization to perform METASYS database migration. Loss or corruption of this database would require complete reprogramming at an estimated cost of \$50,000-\$75,000 and loss of irreplaceable historical data.

4. Warranty and Technical Support: Use of non-JCI hardware would void all existing warranties on \$200,000+ of METASYS field equipment and eliminate access to JCI's 24/7 technical support, software updates, and security patches.

5. Cost-Effectiveness: The JCI upgrade costs \$69,397.44 and preserves existing infrastructure. Complete replacement with an alternative system would cost approximately \$460,000+, representing only 15% of the alternative cost. The JCI solution provides 85% cost savings

Market Research

Comprehensive market research was conducted including:

- OBO Subject Matter Expert (SME) consultation
- Contact with JCI representatives regarding METASYS upgrade capabilities
- Consultation with embassy facilities staff regarding system requirements
- Research of alternative BAS manufacturers (Siemens, Honeywell, Schneider Electric, Tridium)
- Review of METASYS technical documentation and compatibility requirements
- Search of SAM.gov for registered contractors with BAS capabilities
- Review of JCI's authorized integrator list

Market Research Findings: No alternative manufacturer produces hardware or software compatible with existing METASYS infrastructure. METASYS is a closed, proprietary system. JCI does not license METASYS software to third parties or publish specifications that would enable third-party compatibility. All major BAS manufacturers operate similar proprietary systems that require manufacturer-specific hardware and software for upgrades. No small businesses were identified with capability to provide METASYS-compatible hardware and software. Copyright and intellectual property laws prevent any entity other than JCI from providing METASYS software or compatible solutions.

Conclusion: Market research conclusively determined that only JCI can provide the required METASYS-compatible server, laptops, software licenses, and integration services. No reasonable alternatives exist that would preserve the Government's investment in existing METASYS infrastructure.

SECTION 6. DETERMINATION BY THE CONTRACTING OFFICER THAT THE ANTICIPATED COST TO THE GOVERNMENT IS FAIR AND REASONABLE

By signing the justification, the Contracting Officer makes a determination that the price to the Government is anticipated to be fair and reasonable.

An Independent Government Estimate (IGE) has been developed based on:

- OBO Subject Matter Expert (SME) consultation
- Historical cost data from the 2019 METASYS upgrade (adjusted for inflation)
- Commercial pricing for comparable server and laptop hardware



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- Market research on METASYS software licensing costs
- Analysis of labor rates for JCI-certified technicians
- Travel cost estimates for deployment to Libreville, Gabon

The Contracting Officer will conduct price analysis by comparing the offered price to the IGE, analyzing individual cost elements, and validating against market research. The cost-effectiveness analysis demonstrates that the JCI solution provides 85% savings compared to complete system replacement (\$69,397.44 vs. \$460,000+), making it overwhelmingly cost-effective while preserving the Government's \$200,000+ investment in existing infrastructure.



SECTION 7. CERTIFICATIONS

All reviews and approvals should be completed in the order listed unless otherwise authorized or required.

REQUIREMENTS CERTIFICATION

I certify that the facts and representations under my cognizance which are included in this Justification and its supporting acquisition planning documents, except as noted herein, are complete and accurate to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Requirements Cognizance:

SIGNATURE:

LENNOX M. BROWNE
FACILITY MANAGER / POSHO
~~DIRECTOR OF MAINTENANCE / HSE~~

Date

03/31/2026

Facility Manager
Facilities Management, U.S. Embassy Libreville

CONTRACTING OFFICER CERTIFICATION

I certify that this submission is accurate to the best of my knowledge, and that it contains complete information necessary to enable other officials to make an informed recommendation for approval or disapproval.

SIGNATURE:

Nathaniel RUDY
Contracting Officer
General Service Officer, U.S. Embassy Libreville

Date

3/31/2026

